

## Chapter

# Gyan Sarovar, Mount Abu — Woman Is Not Equal, She Is a Thousand Times More Powerful



## Introduction: A Voice in the Valleys of Mount Abu

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On 3 July 2025, the Brahma Kumaris organisation held a national conference at Mount Abu on the theme "Women's Empowerment through Spirituality", attended by more than 500 influential women from every corner of the country. Sadguru Acharya Upendra Ji, founder of the Antar Yog

Foundation, was invited to this event as a distinguished guest.

This chapter is based on the video account of that occasion: the introduction given from the stage, selected excerpts from Acharya Ji's address, and its effect on the audience. In the narrator's words, Acharya Ji "expressed his views on women's empowerment through the knowledge of Vedanta, in simple and clear words."

## **1. The Introduction from the Stage: "A Burning Lamp"**

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After the auspicious lighting of the lamp, a senior Brahma Kumari sadhika introduced Acharya Ji:

"You are a jivanmukta spiritual Sadguru, a revolutionary hero and an ocean of knowledge, who has been selflessly and continuously serving his motherland since 2005. Acharya Ji does not merely teach the scriptures; he lives his own life according to the scriptures."

She also highlighted Acharya Ji's purpose:

"To make India healthy, prosperous and a spiritual guide, and to re-establish her as Vishwa Guru, the teacher of the world, is your supreme aim."

And she compared him to Arjuna's declaration:

"In the darkness of Maya spread all around, your life of service is a burning lamp. In this hour of crisis, you have declared like Arjuna — 'na dainyaṁ na palāyanam', meaning that on the path of your duty you keep moving forward, always firmly resolved."

Na dainyaṁ na palāyanam — "neither helplessness nor flight": neither bowing down in defeat, nor running away from duty.

## **2. Woman Is Not Equal, She Is a Thousand Times More Powerful**

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The common question today is whether woman is equal to man. Acharya Ji's answer changes the question itself:

"A woman, nari, is never equal to a man — she is a thousand times, at the very least, more powerful."

Empowerment does not mean asking for equality; it means recognising the power that is already present.

### 3. Ati Saumya, Ati Raudra: Power Used the Wrong Way Round

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To explain the nature of this power, Acharya Ji points to Goddess Durga:

"Read the Durga Saptashati — ati saumya, ati raudra."

In the **Durga Saptashati**, the Goddess is described as at once extremely **saumya** (gentle, serene) and extremely **raudra** (fierce, terrible). Acharya Ji's concern is that today these two forms appear in the wrong places:

"So the fierce form often comes out in front of the husband, and the gentle form comes out outside. However much atrocity there is outside, she bears it. Whereas that is not what she was meant to do."

Fierce at home and gentle before the injustice outside — this order of power is reversed, and it has to change.

## 4. Ardhanarishvara: The One Thing Missing for Vishwa Guru

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According to Acharya Ji, India has everything it needs to become Vishwa Guru — except one thing:

"For India to be Vishwa Guru, we have all the knowledge, all the powers. One thing is missing — India has not yet come into the Ardhanarishvara state. It is still a male-dominated society."

**Ardhanarishvara** — the form of Shiva in which half the body is Shiva and half is Shakti; the perfect balance of the male and female principles. Acharya Ji gives a direct proof of this imbalance:

"How many women have become Prime Minister in our country? Few — one. So why not the others?"

From here his resolve is born:

"So for that I said, come, let us start the work — and it is only through women's empowerment that this is going to happen."

## 5. A Woman's Intuition: The Train Compartment

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"But how will it happen?" In answer, Acharya Ji draws attention to an innate power of women, through an everyday scene:

"If you enter a compartment and all the window seats have been taken by some men, and you have to travel — it is a journey of just 20 minutes. Even then a woman has so much intuition power — 'Who? This one looks a bit bad; this one seems a bit like a goon.'"

"She has that intuitive power, and she can go and sit exactly next to the one among them who looks decent."

This intuition, which sizes up a person in a few moments, is a power that comes naturally to a woman.

## 6. Smriti, Dhriti, Medha: A Woman's Power of Retention

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Acharya Ji names three more qualities of women — **smriti** (memory), **dhriti** (the power of holding, retention) and **medha** (the intelligence to present what was once heard or known, exactly, at the right time). These are the very qualities that the Lord, in the Bhagavad Gita (10.34), names as His own glory in women. He explains dhriti this way:

"Dhriti — dhriti means the power of dharana, holding on something for very long time."

And then with a light-hearted example every household will recognise:

"If some man asks, 'So where did I go wrong?', I always tell him: just go to your wife and say this much — 'Tell me what one mistake he made.' She can probably tell you everything — what mistakes you, your mother, your family made, and when — at the right time."

"This is that smriti, dhriti too, and medha. At the right time — right at the function she will go and tell it and talk about it!"

**Smriti, dhriti and medha are a woman's natural powers — the only question is in which direction they are used.**

## **7. From Mother to Bharat Mata: The Path to Vishwa Guru**

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The central thread of the address comes as a ladder — from mother to Guru, from Guru to Bharat Mata:

"Until you understand a mother, you cannot understand the Guru, you cannot understand the Guru-Mother. Until you understand the Guru-Mother, you cannot understand Bharat Mata."

And on this touchstone he tests India's aspiration to become Vishwa Guru:

"If India is to become Vishwa Guru, then what I say is: apart from India, the people of the world are of all the other faiths, all the other countries — when will they listen to you? What will they listen to? Are we ready to understand them like a mother, right now?"

To become Vishwa Guru, India first needs a mother's heart — one that can understand the whole world as its own children.

## 8. The Impact of the Address

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According to the narrator, the address not only astonished the women present but also made them feel that, in Acharya Ji's eyes, woman is "not ordinary, but supremely worthy of worship and powerful." After the session, many women met Acharya Ji personally to express their gratitude; they found his words practical and logical, and found solutions to problems in their own lives.

## Summary: Key Teachings

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- 1** Woman is not equal to man; she is at least a thousand times more powerful — empowerment lies in recognising that power.
- 2** **Ati saumya, ati raudra** — Durga has both forms, but today the fierce form comes out before the husband and the gentle form before the atrocities outside; this reversed order must change.
- 3** India lacks only one thing: it has not yet come into the **Ardhanarishvara** state. Only through women's empowerment will India become Vishwa Guru.
- 4** A woman's intuition lets her tell the right person from the wrong one within moments.
- 5** **Smriti, dhriti, medha** — the power to hold on for a long time and to present at the right time comes naturally to women.
- 6** Without understanding the mother, one cannot understand the Guru; without understanding the Guru-Mother, one cannot understand Bharat Mata.

**7 To become Vishwa Guru, India must be ready to understand the whole world as a mother does.**